CHALLENGE SHEET

Vault Api

Inspect an internal employee management API and recover a protected employee archive. The lab starts with a low-privileged analyst account and explores how security boundaries are enforced across an API.

DIFFICULTY	TRACK	HOST PORT	LAB ID
MEDIUM	WEB	8080	vault-api

EASY | MEDIUM | HARD | INSANE

VERIFY THE SOLVE

```
• python3 ../scripts/check.py vault-api
```

Brief

`vault-api` is a fictional internal employee management API. A protected employee archive is stored in the system. You receive a low-privileged analyst account and must find a way to recover the archive and its flag.

Setup

Copy the environment template, then build and start the challenge:

```
cp .env.example .env
docker compose up --build -d
```

Wait for the container to become healthy, then confirm the API responds:

```
curl -s http://localhost:8080/health
```

The API is available at `http://localhost:8080`.

You start with the following account:

Username	Password
analyst	analyst123

Goal

Recover the flag from the protected employee archive. The flag matches the format `duck{...}`.

Rules

- Only interact with the provided challenge instance.
- Do not attempt to escape the container or attack the host system.

- Do not perform denial-of-service attacks.

Reset

To reset the challenge to its initial state:

```
docker compose down -v
docker compose up --build -d
```

This restores the database and seeded data.